



△ Enslaved Africans panning for gold in Brazil

## 1693 BRAZILIAN GOLD

The discovery of gold deposits in southeast Brazil in 1693 triggered the world's first "gold rush". Tens of thousands of Portuguese migrated to their country's colony in hope of riches. By 1730, Brazil was producing 10,000 kg (22,000 lb) of gold a year.

**1694 The Bank of England** is founded: the institution will finance the growth of the British Empire

**1694 The Quilombo dos Palmares**, a community of thousands of self-emancipated people, is crushed in Brazil

1694



△ The Sicilian earthquake, engraving

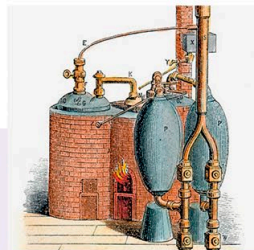
## 1693 SICILIAN EARTHQUAKE

A huge earthquake struck southeast Sicily on 11 January 1693. In the cities of Catania and Ragusa, worst hit by the disaster, more than half the population were killed and most buildings destroyed. Damage spread as far afield as Malta, with a tsunami following the tremor. The total death toll is reckoned to have reached 60,000.

## 1690-1775 EARLY STEAM ENGINES



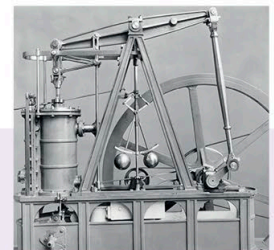
**1690 Physicist Denis Papin**, a French Huguenot living in Germany, builds the first model of a piston steam engine.



**1698 Thomas Savery**, an English engineer, invents a steam-powered water pump that becomes a commercial success.



**1712 Thomas Newcomen**, an English inventor, makes his ground-breaking "atmospheric engine" to pump water out of mines.



**1763 Scottish inventor James Watt** improves Newcomen's design, creating a more versatile engine to power factories.

Although steam-driven devices existed in antiquity, engines that powered the Industrial Revolution were developed from the 1690s.